EmPaper. What we are building and how it works

Plain-English overview for the founder. Updated 16 October 2026.

What EmPaper is

EmPaper is an HR website that companies pay for. Their staff log in to see pay letters, request time off, look up colleagues and read company announcements. You sell it to companies, and each company gets its own space with its own logo and colours.

The three "doors"

1. Public website
Anyone reads about EmPaper and fills in the demo form.
Live

2. Owner console
Your private dashboard, like WordPress. Only you can enter. You run the business here.
Being built

3. Client portals
A client's HR team, then their staff, use the actual HR product. Each company sees only its own data.
Later

We are building door 2 first, so you can run the business before any client arrives.

How a client goes through the system

1. **Someone requests a demo.** They fill in the form on your site: name, company, work email, team size, what interests them, and two new optional questions: "*Does your company have a logo?*" (Yes / No, not yet / Not sure) and "*Your brand colours*" (typed, such as "navy and gold"). You get an email alert and the request is saved privately. Works today*
2. **You see it in your console.** Sign in at */admin/login* and open **Demo requests**. Mark each one "I've contacted them", "Good fit" and so on, and keep private notes. You also see their logo and colour answers. Works today
3. **A good lead becomes a client.** Click **Convert to client**. The system creates the company record and the lead shows "Became a client". Next (Phase 3)
4. **You collect their look.** Click **Create branding link** and send it by WhatsApp or email. The client opens it, with no account, uploads their logo and picks their colours, and sees a live preview. **If they have no logo they tick "We don't have a logo"**, and the system uses their company name as a text logo. You review and approve. Phase 4
5. **You give their HR person access.** Click **Invite HR admin** and copy the ready-made message with a link. You send it yourself, because there is no domain for automatic emails yet. They open the link, choose a password, and land on a page with their company's logo and colours. Phase 5

6 **Their HR team and staff use the product.** HR adds employees and uploads pay letters; staff log in to see their own. Later

> **Why the logo upload is not on the demo form.** A visitor is not a client yet. An open upload on a public page invites spam, storage costs and unsafe files, and a longer form means fewer people finish it. So the demo form only asks two quick questions, and the real upload happens on the private link after they become a client.
>
> *The two new questions go live after the database change is applied.

How it works underneath

PART	WHAT IT DOES
Website	Hosted on Vercel. Vercel also runs small server programs, such as the email alert.
Database and logins	On Supabase. The database decides who may see what. That is the real lock, so even someone who opens a private page directly sees nothing without permission.
Code and safety checks	On GitHub. Every change goes through a pull request with automatic checks, and you click Merge.
Who is who	You are the **owner**, one special account that sees everything. An HR admin or employee sees only their own company's data.

Where we are

Done	Marketing site, demo form and email alerts. Owner database and security. Owner sign-in and the demo requests page.
Next	Convert to client (Phase 3).
Then	Branding link with the no-logo option (Phase 4), HR invite (Phase 5). Later: HR portal, employee portal, pricing page in both Ghana cedis and US dollars.

Before the first paying client

- Upgrade Vercel and Supabase to paid plans (commercial use, backups, no pausing).
- Buy a domain and set up transactional email, so invites and alerts can be sent automatically.
- Get a Ghana data-protection lawyer: Data Protection Act 2012, a data processing agreement per client, privacy policy and terms.

EmPaper project notes. The same information, with the working rules, is kept in the project folder under docs/ so it follows you between computers.